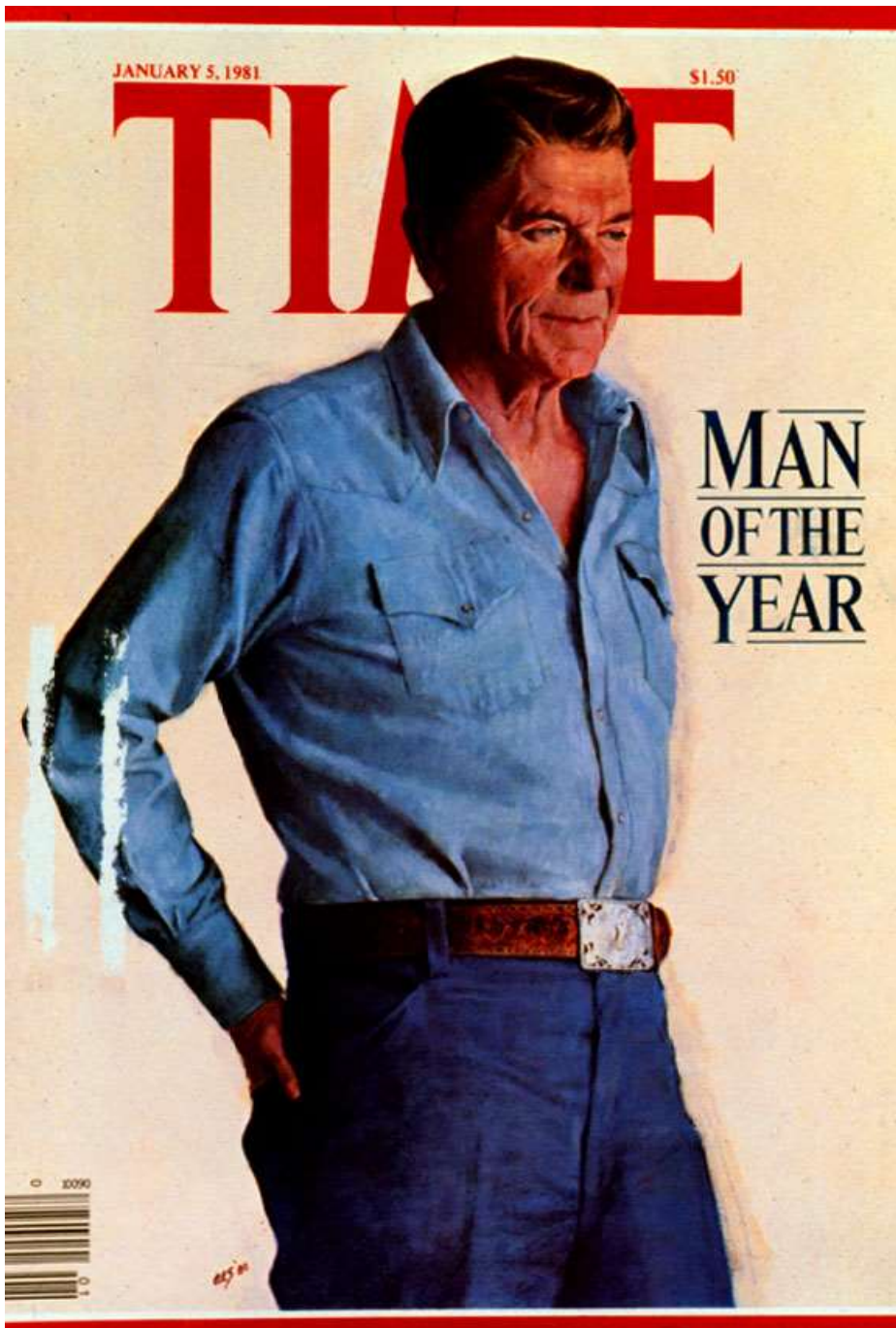




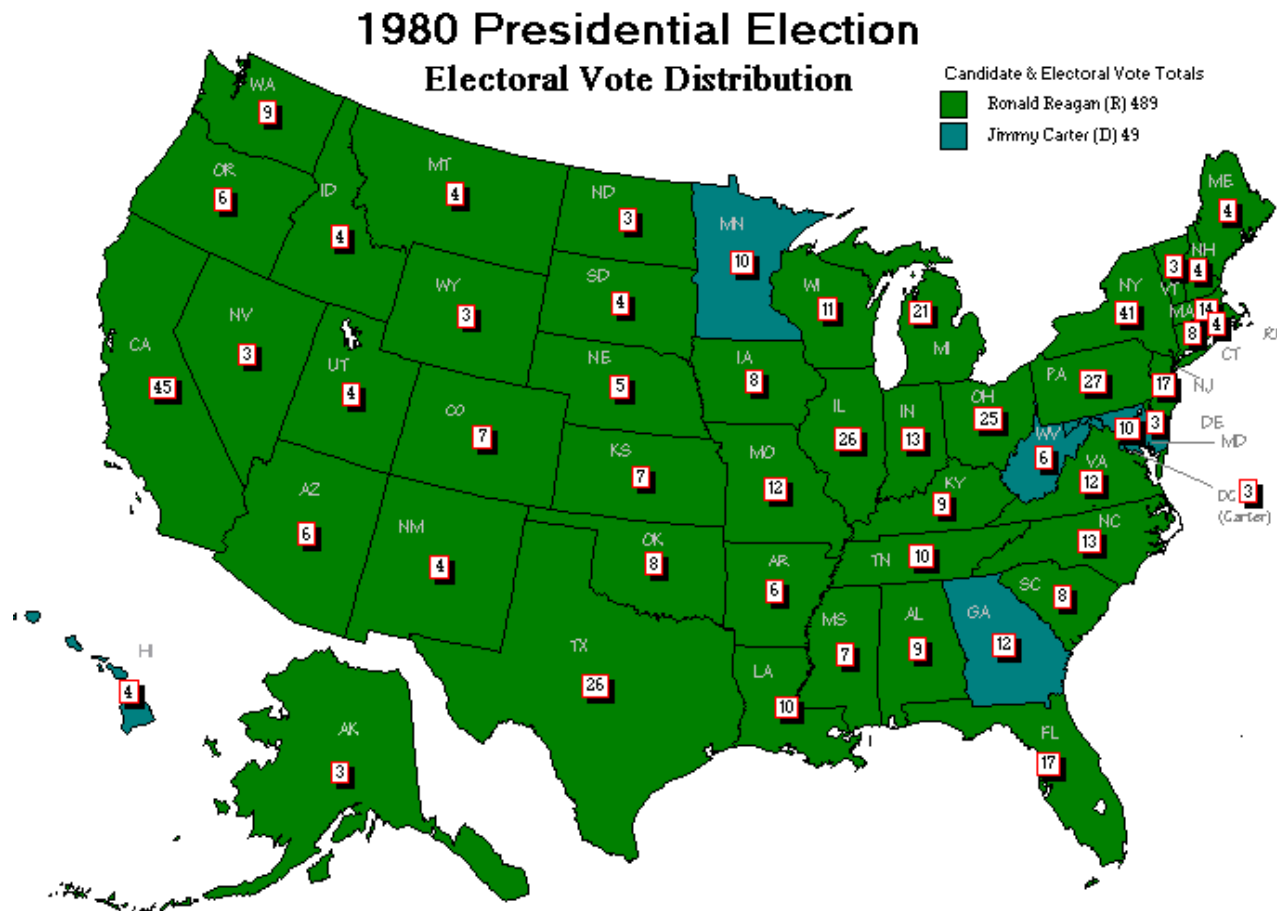
Ronald Reagan

- Gap Rhetoric/reality
 - Economics
 - Use of Force
 - Iran-Contra
- Relations with USSR
 - Phase 1: Evil Empire
 - Phase 2: Let's Talk
- The 1988 Election

George H. W. Bush

- The Collapse of the USSR
- The End of the Cold War

Reagan wins in landslide

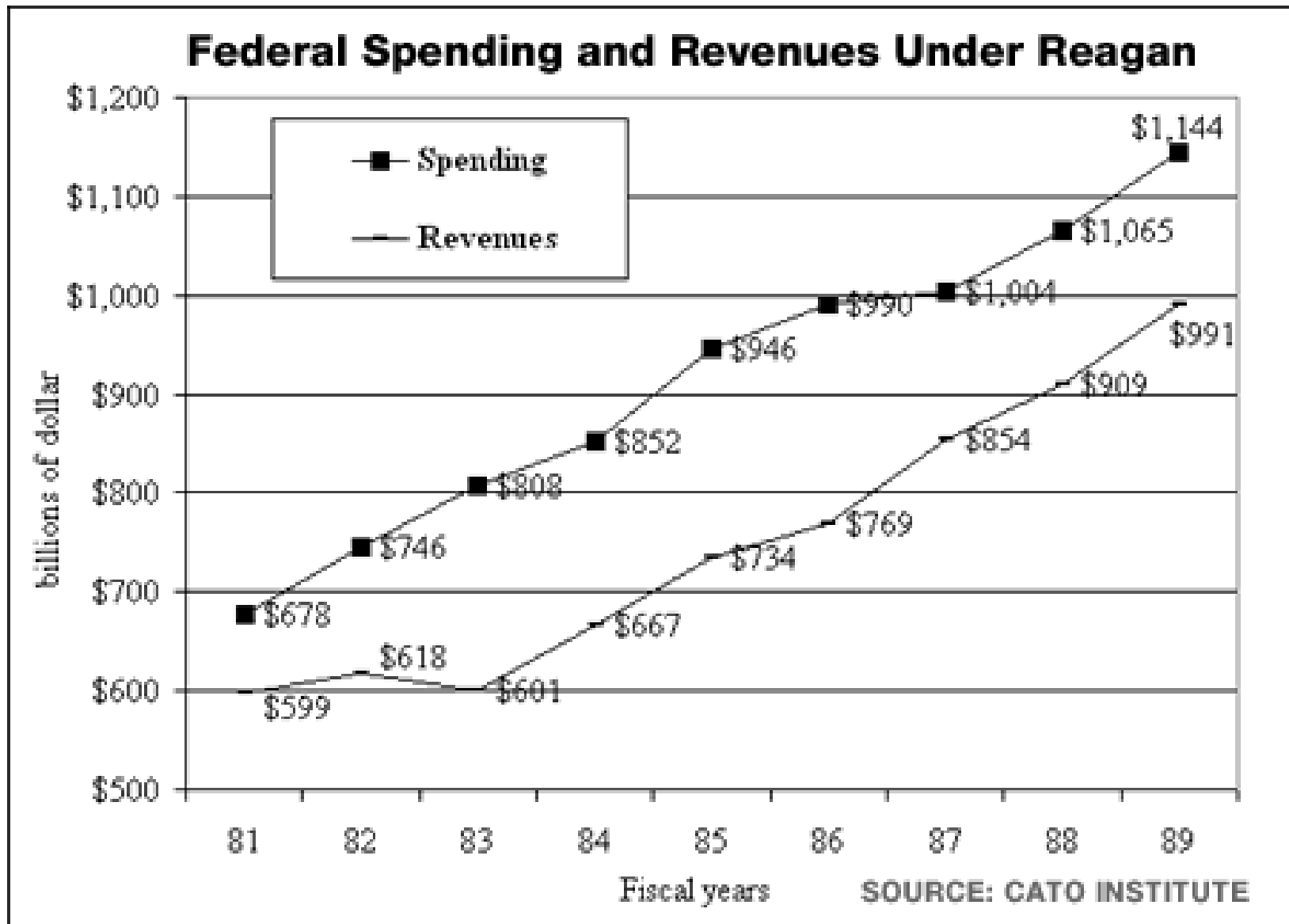




And, on Inauguration Day, the hostages are released.



RR *said* he was a fiscal conservative,
but he was a big spender

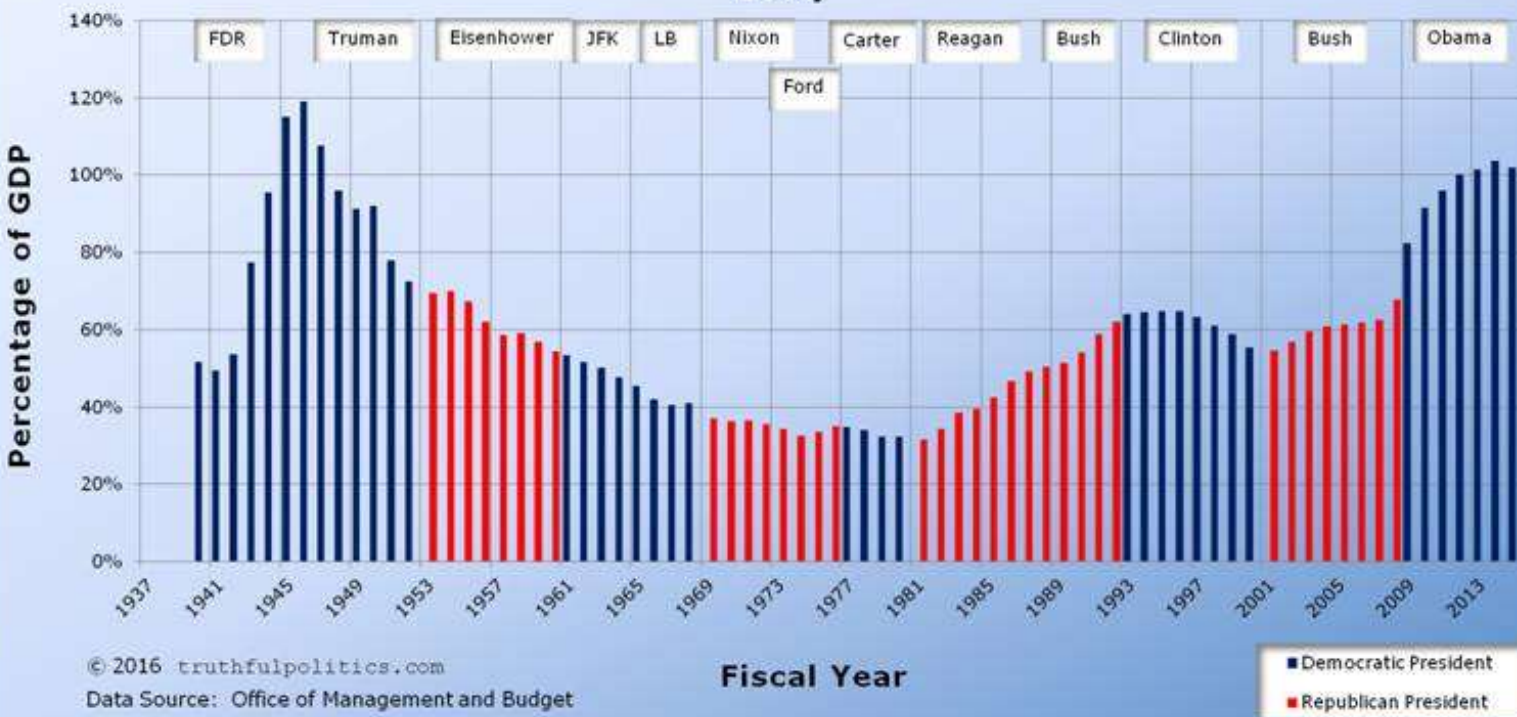


US federal deficit, 1981 = \$79 billion;
1988 = \$221 billion



In 1982, when this cartoon was drawn, the budget forecast a \$91.5 billion deficit
(in 2017=\$779 billion; estimate for 2019=\$1 trillion)

U.S. Federal Debt as a Percentage of GDP by President / Political Party

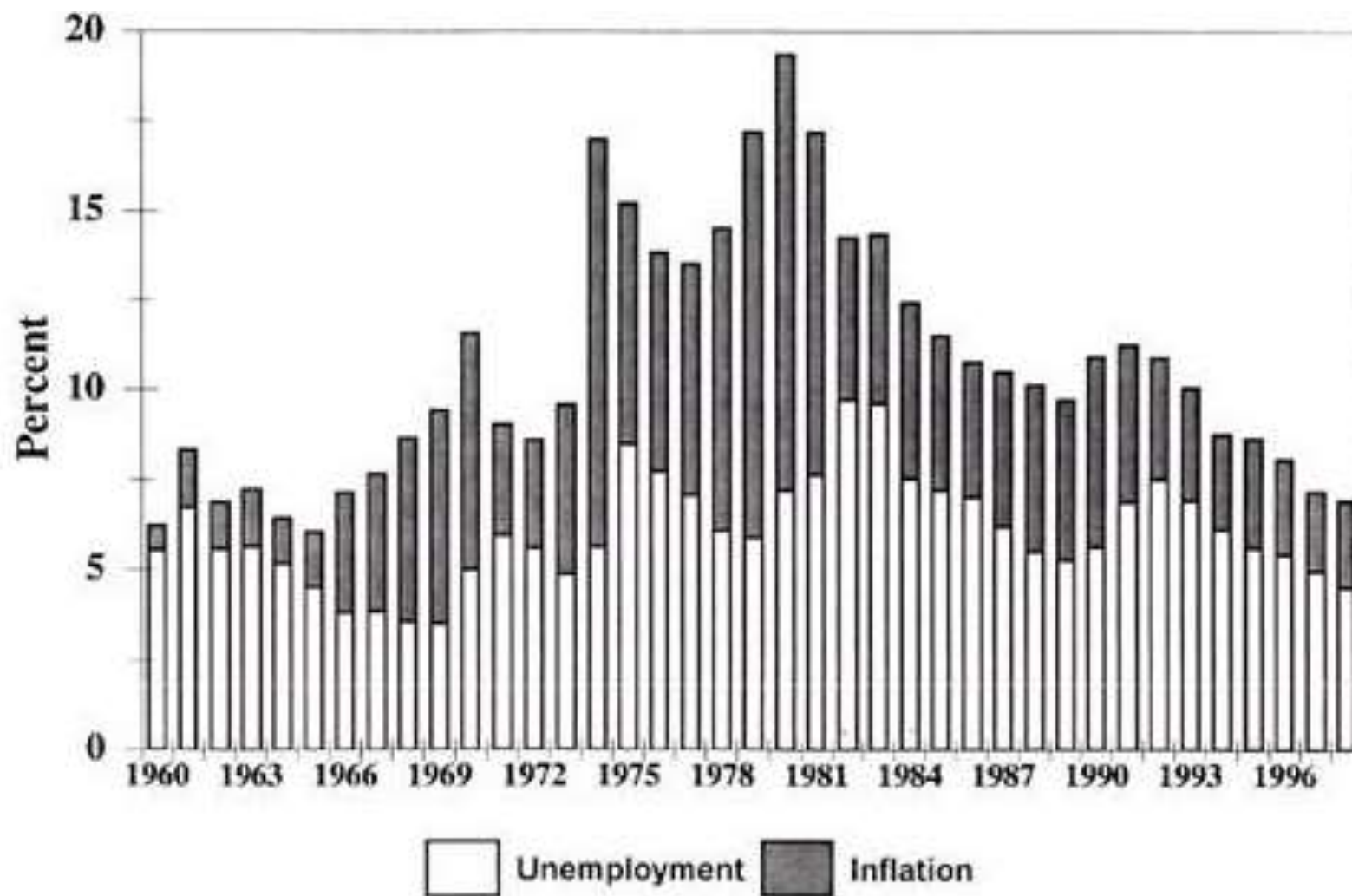


In 2019, it was 105.4%

Unemployment rose sharply in 1st term, peaking at 10.5%; and fell in 2nd



The “Misery Index” stayed high.



RR *talked* about using military force,
but his actions were timid.

He sent US Marines to Lebanon.
Their barracks were bombed in 1983.



Oct. 23: 241 Americans were killed.



RR said he would “stand tall,” but he withdrew the Marines from Lebanon in 1984





The Iran-Contra Scandal

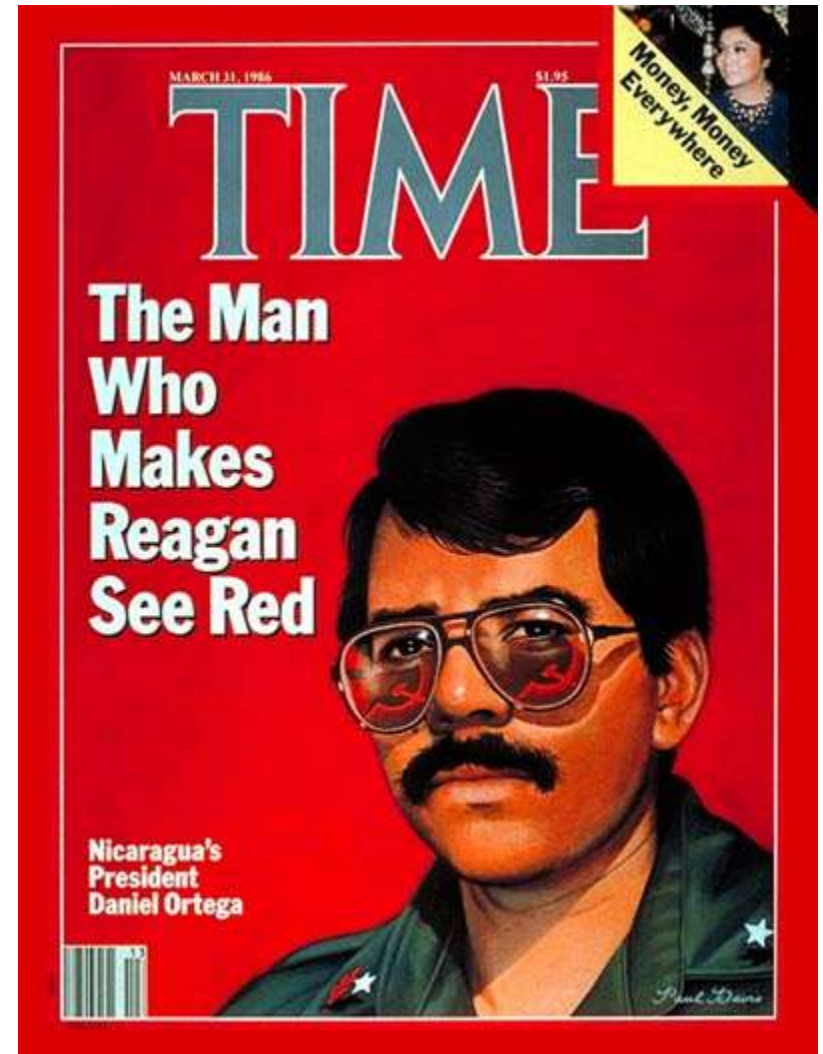
US hostages are
seized in
Lebanon.
RR believes Iran
can get their
release.
He illegally ***sells***
weapons to
Iran.



PROBLEM:

how to launder the money
from the profits of the sale?

Reagan called the leftist government in Nicaragua a threat to American security.



He supported guerillas opposing the regime. They were called “Contras.”



This was the litmus test of a true Reaganite.

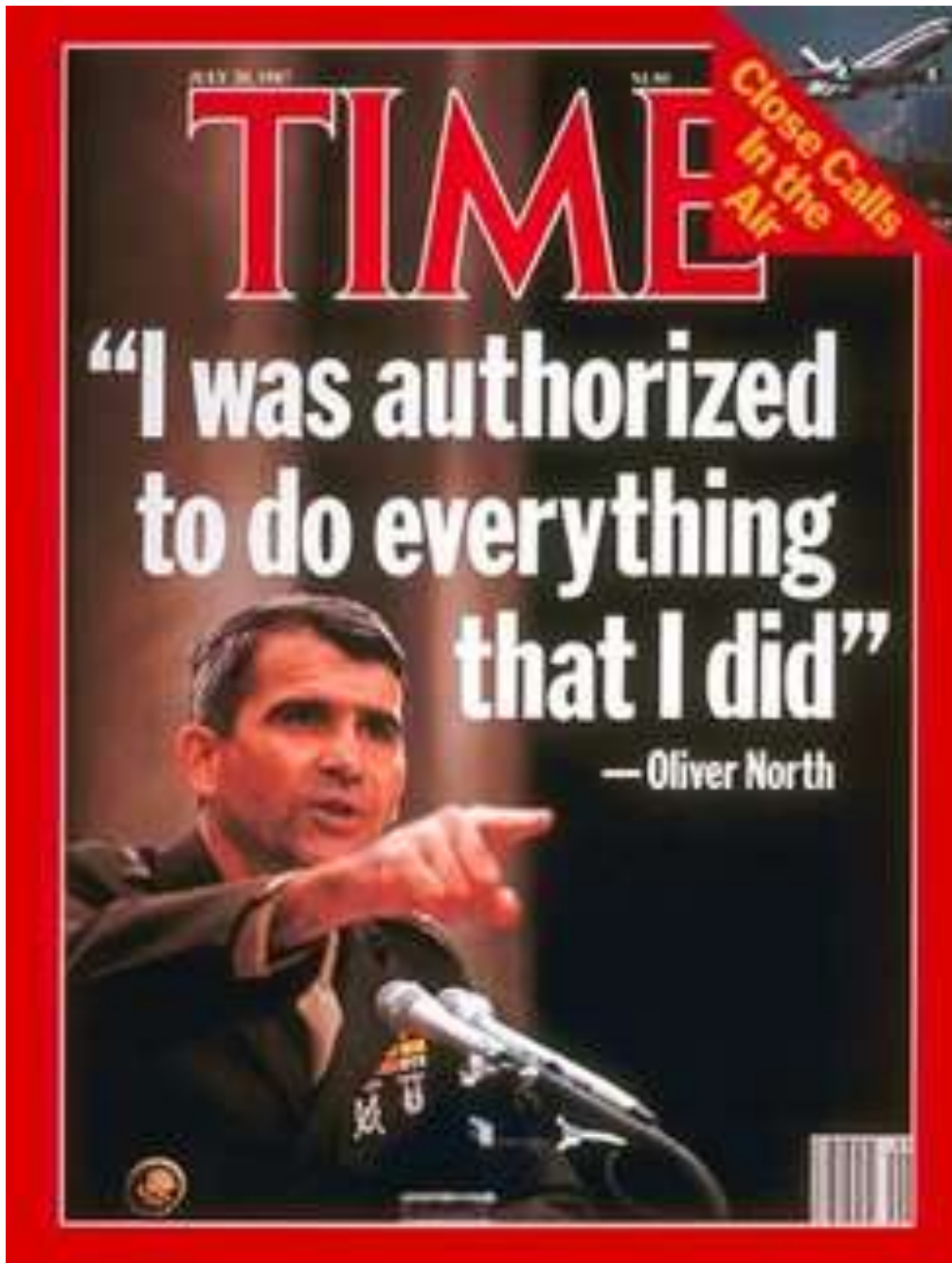


Congress balked.



It refused to keep funding the Contras





The solution:
transfer
the money
from the
illegal arms deal
with Iran
to the Contras.

RR and the Soviet Union: Two Phases

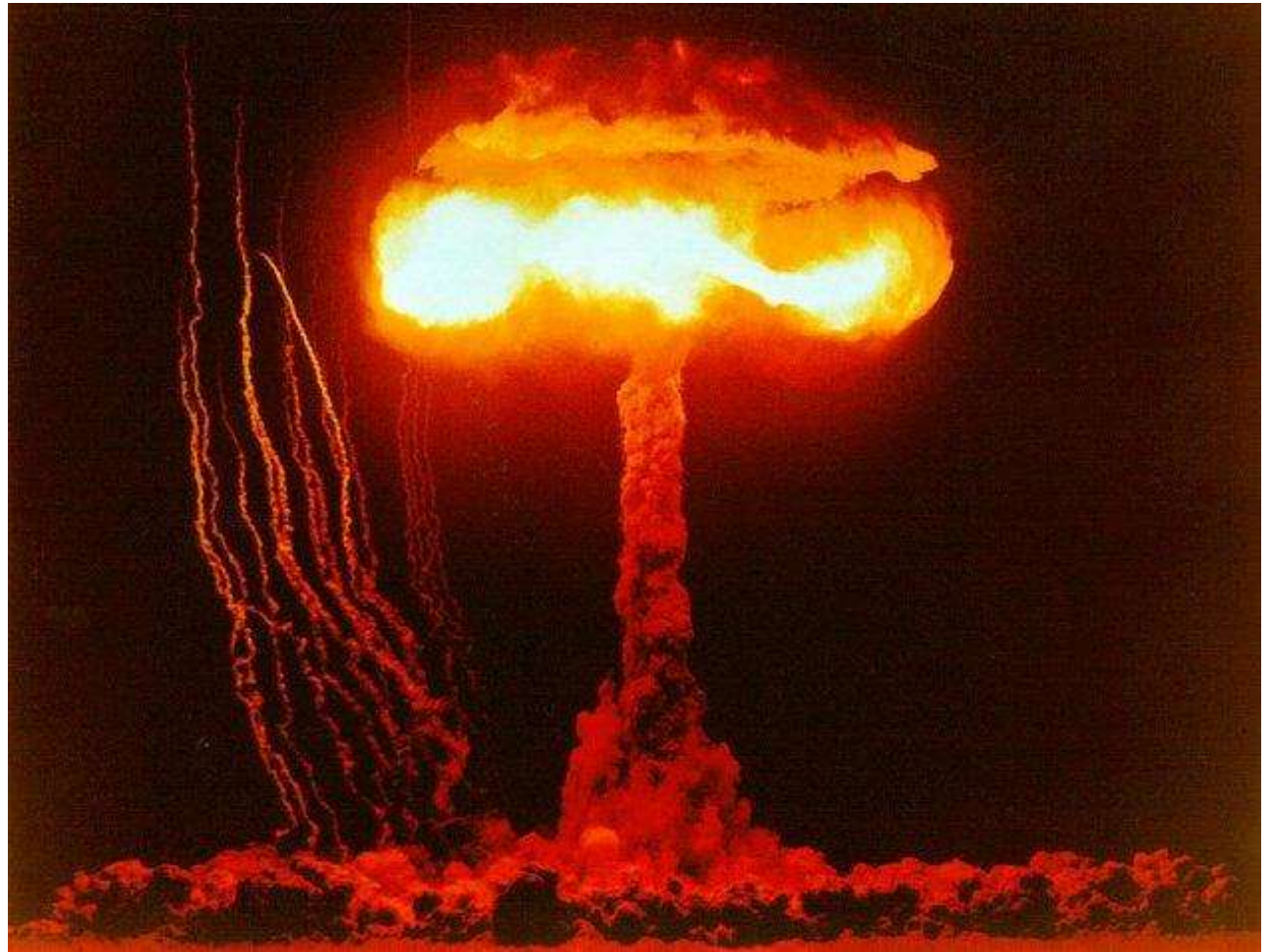
(1) 1981-1983 – The “Evil Empire”

RR will leave it “on the ash-heap of history”



Reagan & his aides talked about waging nuclear war – and winning.

"Yes, there could be a limited nuclear war in Europe."
Reagan,
1981



➤ "The human race is very resilient. Some estimates predict that in a limited nuclear war as many as 10 million people might perish on one side and 100 million on the other



Arms Control Agency
head Eugene Rostow
(1981)

... but that is not the whole of the population."



People were scared – in US and in Europe.
The Nuclear Freeze Movement



By 1983, RR's approval ratings were falling
& he was facing the '84 campaign.



Nancy Reagan
convinced
him to
tone down his
rhetoric.

The Cold War was getting more and more complicated.



<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NpwdcmjBgNA>

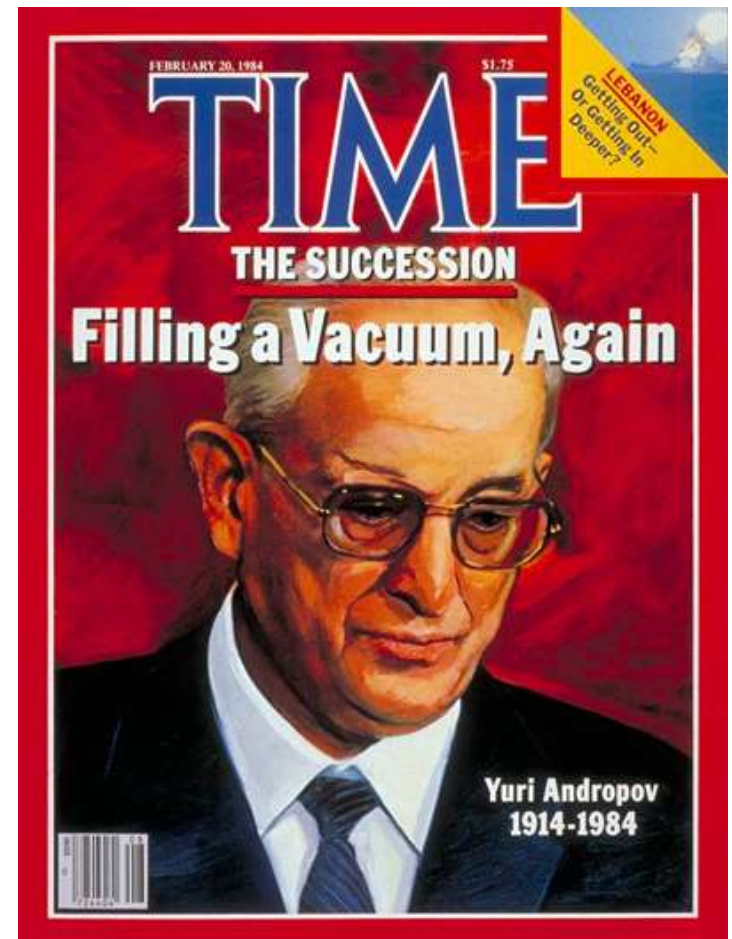
RR beat Mondale in '84



But he had trouble opening talks with USSR.
Problem: USSR leaders kept dying.

Andropov died Feb. 1984

Brezhnev died, Nov. 1982



It was the end of the WW2 generation in Soviet leadership.

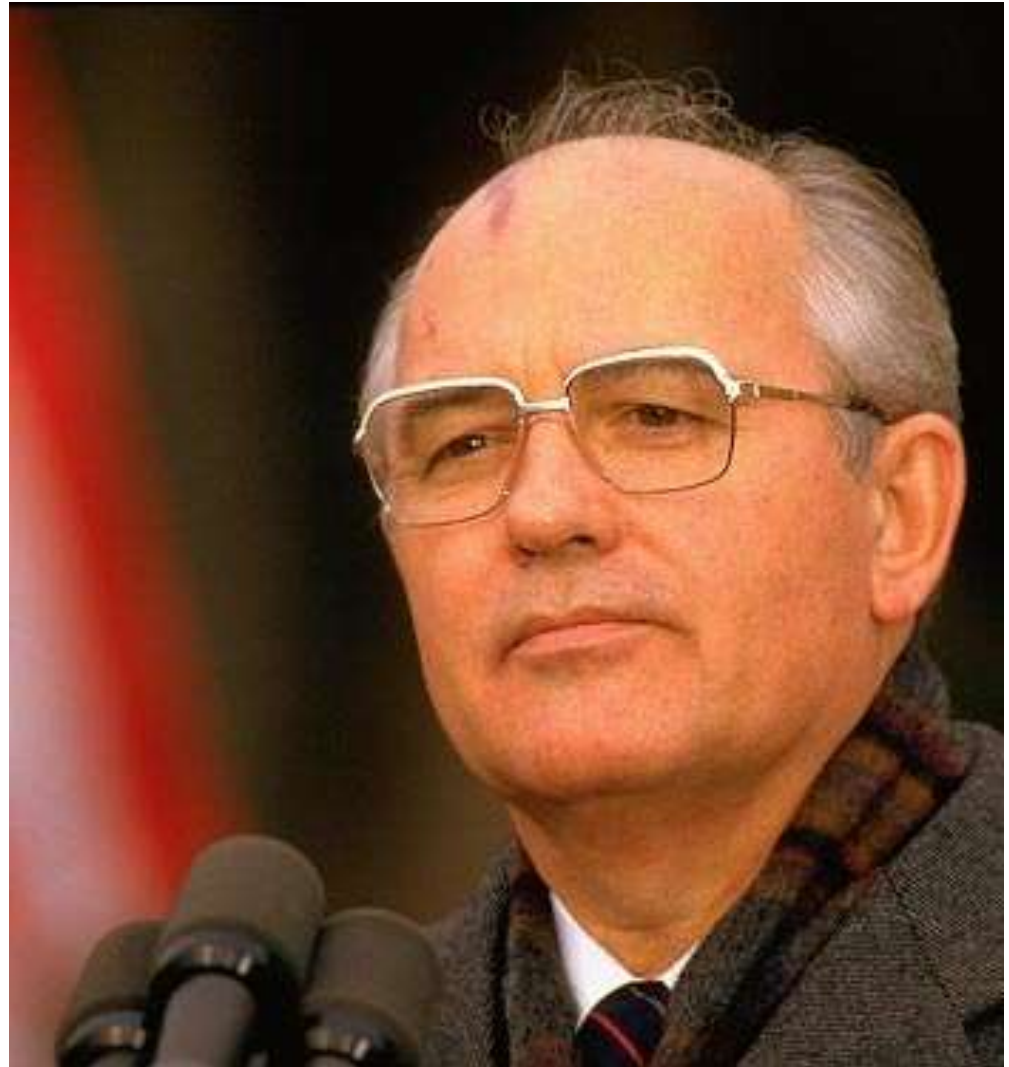
Chernenko died March 1985



- Brezhnev, born 1906
- Andropov, born 1914
- Chernenko, born 1911

A new generation in USSR: Mikhail Gorbachev

Born 1931.
Recognized need to
revitalize Soviet
economy.
Introduced
“perestroika”
(restructuring) and
“glasnost”
(opening).





Reagan and
“Gorby”
held a series of
summits.

Gorbachev set off a process of liberalization in the USSR that he could not control



The foundations
began to crack.



Soviets withdraw from Afghanistan, 1988



US Election of 1988



Vice
President
Bush
defeats
Dukakis.



US Election of 1988



Vice
President
Bush
defeats
Dukakis.



The George H. W. Bush Presidency



“41”

(not “43”)

The End of the Cold War

The First Gulf War

Remember the Berlin Wall,
begun in the JFK years?



Nov. 10, 1989: Morning at the Brandenburg Gate.
Thousands climb the Wall from the Western side.
The East Germany army stands guard.



And the wall came tumbling down.



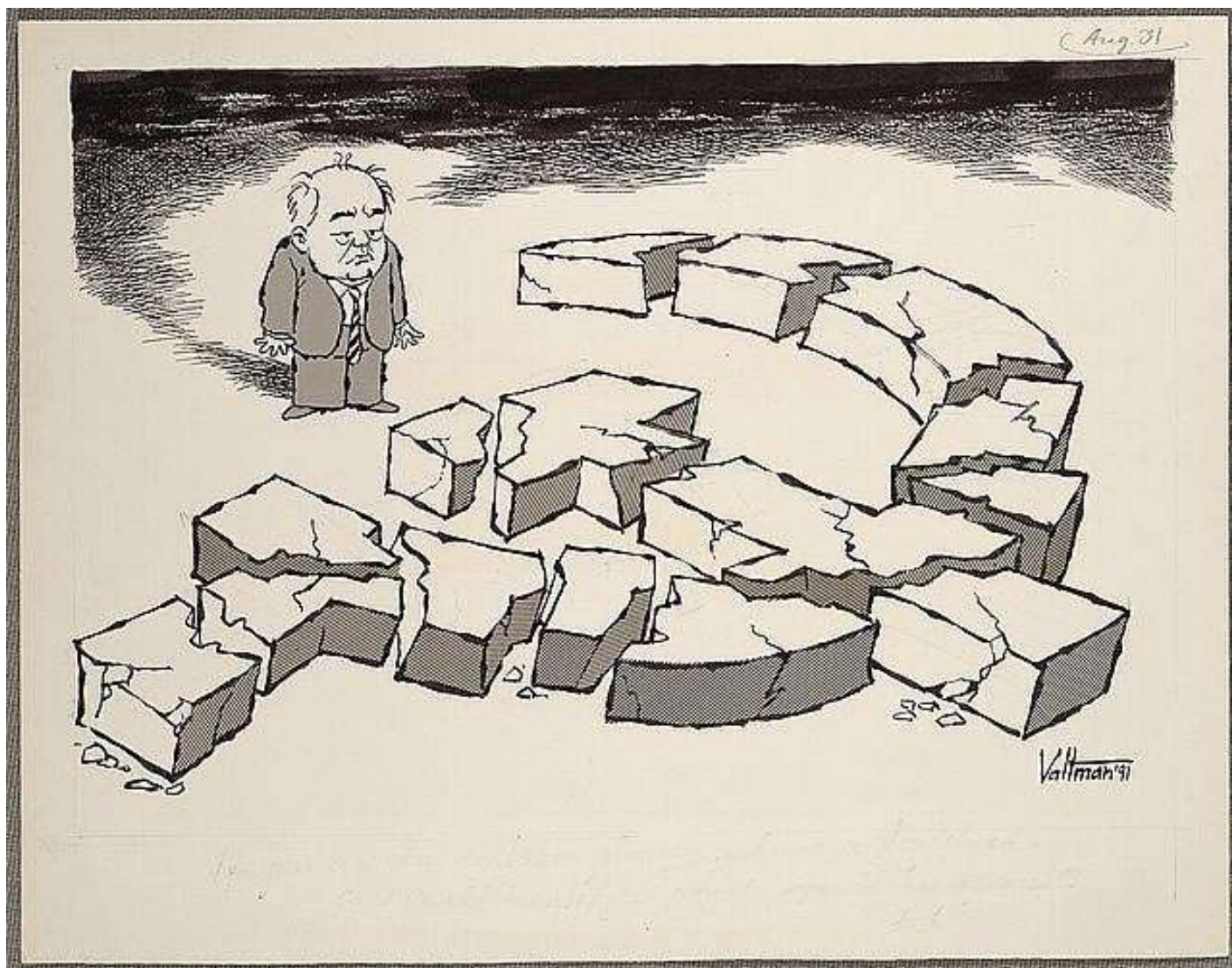
© 2002 by Jürgen Müller-Schneek, Berlin

Tears of Emotion

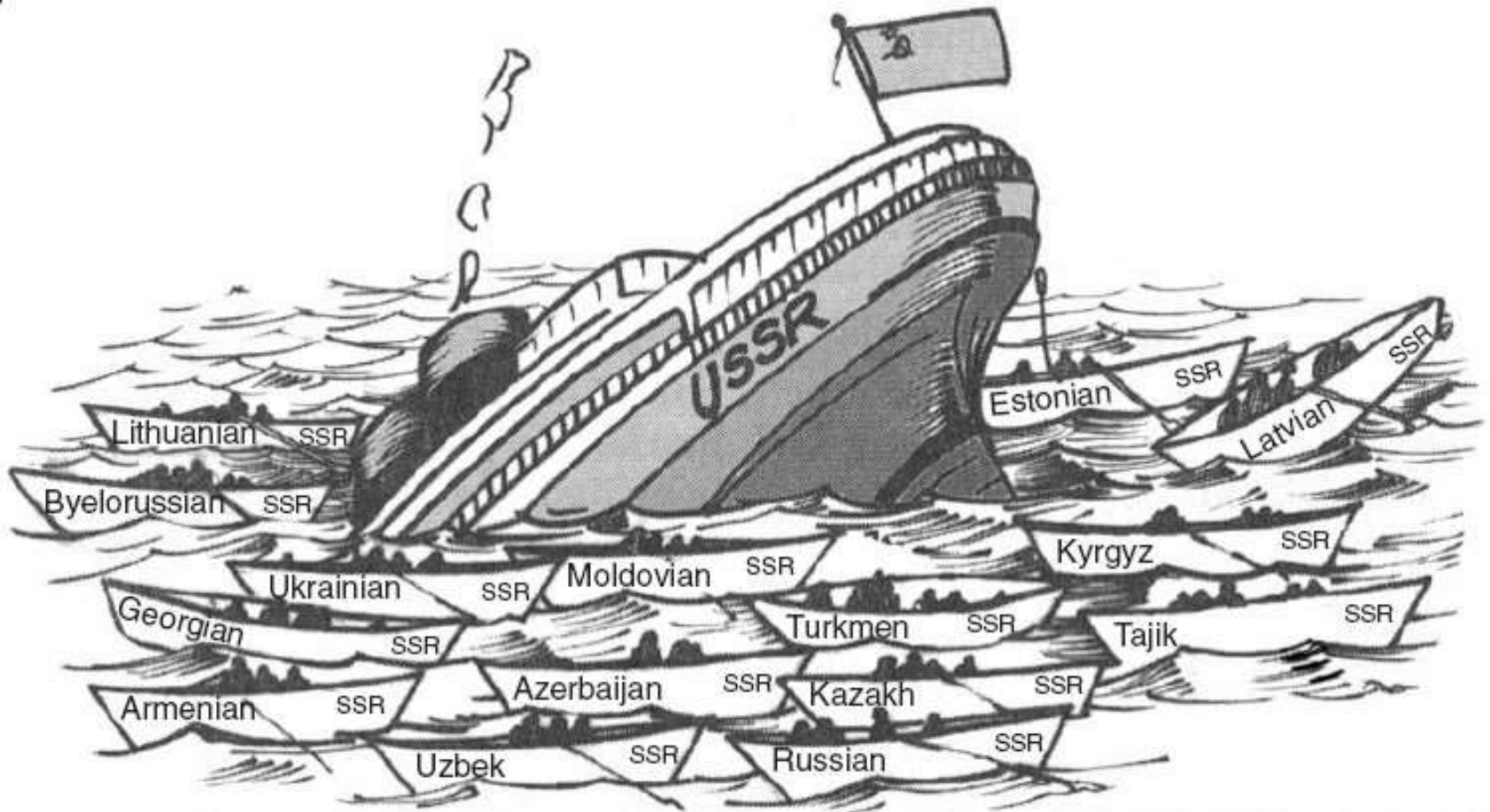
An East Berlin woman enters the western part of Berlin.
November 11th 1989



1991: The Soviet Union is dissolved.



The “Soviet Socialist Republics” break away



Commonwealth of Independent States



The Cold War (1) Cost the US lives in Korea, Vietnam, and other interventions



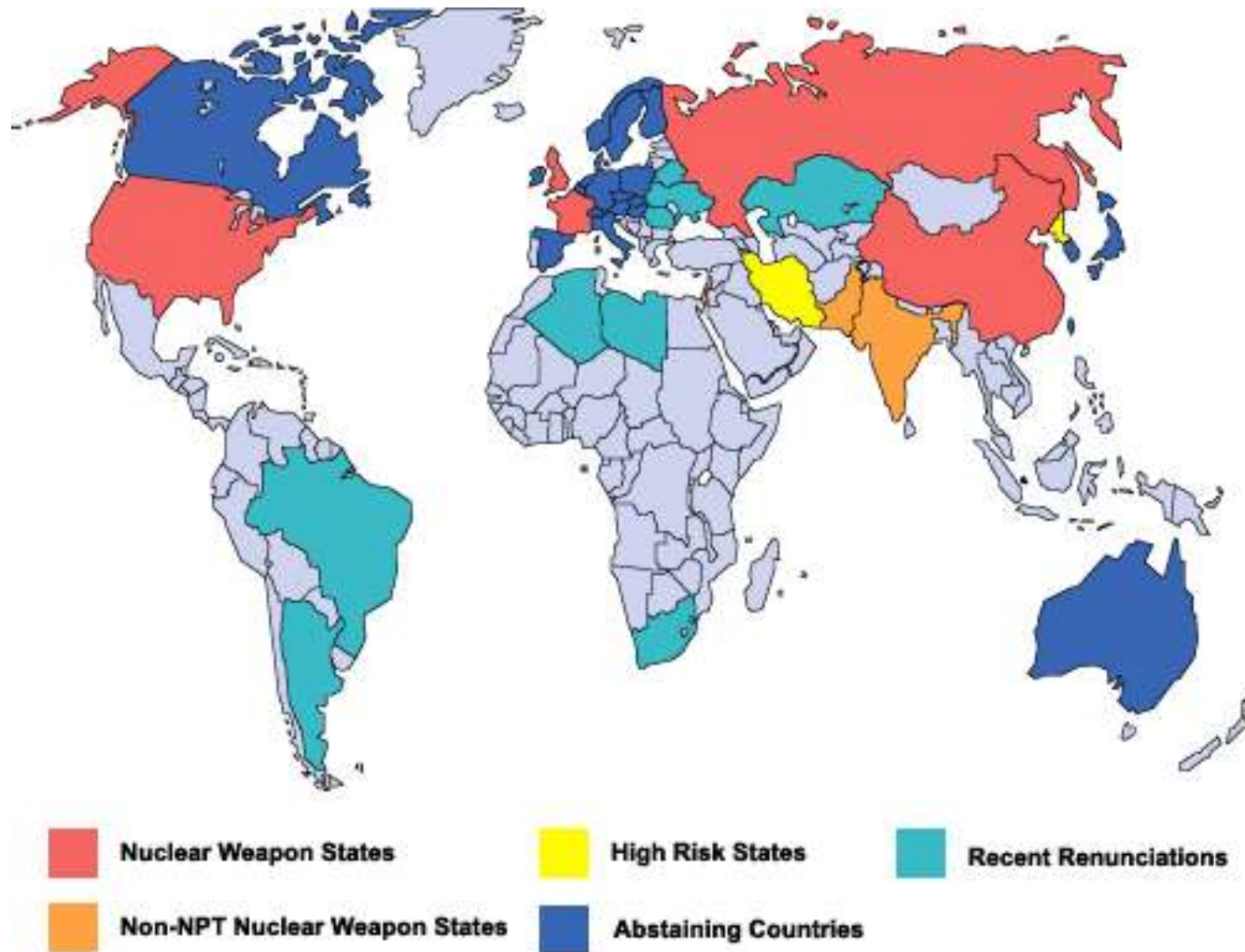
(2) Cost approximately \$18.5 trillion



(3) Cost
many million
lives of
Vietnamese,
Koreans,
Angolans,
Nicaraguans,
Soviets,
Chinese, etc.
etc.



(4) Led to the nuclearization of the world.



Why did the Cold War end?

- All theories are tentative.
- Much of the evidence from USSR & US archives is still classified.



Remember: Levels of Analysis: man – state – system

The MAN level:

The evidence indicates that Gorbachev – not Reagan – is primarily responsible for the collapse of the USSR.



The Soviet Union collapsed *from within*.

Now consider the **STATE** level:
The Soviet economic system didn't work as well as the US system.



- Soviet standard of living, 1980s = $\frac{1}{3}$ that of USA.
- Chronic consumer shortages in USSR.

Now consider
the INTERNATIONAL SYSTEM



Increasing TV & travel between
East & West Europe
fueled discontent in East Europe.



Prague, 1989

Idea of Human Rights spread through USSR



Pope John Paul II
in Poland, 1979



Solidarity Movement
in Poland, 1980s

USSR Army bogged down in unpopular war in Afghanistan



Finally, remember George Kennan and containment?



Deputy Chief of Mission, US Embassy, Moscow

Remember: He predicted that US could defeat USSR without war



Kremlin is like a wind-up toy. If US **contains** USSR so it cannot expand, Soviet leaders will lose legitimacy. Soviet system will run out of steam & collapse in about 10 years.

Lippmann's alternative in 1947

- The problem is in Europe – not the periphery
- US MUST try to negotiate with Soviets



Walter Lippmann
Prominent US journalist

Lippmann's alternative: Must settle the German Question



Was Kennan right?
Or was Lippmann?



Walter Lippmann
Prominent US journalist

Some say Kennan:
US practiced
CONTAINMENT &
USSR ran out of
steam



But: what IMAGE comes to mind
when I say
“end of the Cold War”?





The Cold War ended when Germany was reunited. Was Lippmann right?

**Could the Cold War have
been avoided?**